

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Gaber Langhi

Address: 3 Balmoral Way Sutton SM2 6PD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to express my strong support for Planning Application DM2025/01591.

I have been a homeowner on Balmoral Way since 1993 and have lived directly next to the former ambulance station for over three decades. During that time, I have seen Belmont change considerably - families grow, new neighbours arrive, schools expand, and the community evolve. While the area has developed in many positive ways, one thing that has consistently been lacking is a dedicated, well-organised community facility that can properly serve local residents of all ages.

Having lived beside the site for so many years, I am very familiar with its history and its impact on the immediate surroundings. When it operated as an ambulance station, there were regular vehicle movements, flashing blue lights and sirens at all hours, including late at night and early in the morning. That was understandably part of its essential function. In comparison, the proposed use as a Place of Worship and Community Hub represents a far more predictable and moderate use of the site.

The location of the building is, in my view, ideal for local residents. I personally walk to community events that have been held in Belmont and have done so regularly over the past several years, and I know many neighbours who do the same. The site is perfectly placed within the heart of the community. It is literally just down the road from where current activities take place at St John's Community Hall. Residents like myself value being able to walk to local events, and this proposal simply builds on an existing pattern of community activity in the area. I do not believe it would introduce anything materially different from what residents are already used to, nor would it cause disturbance beyond normal and reasonable community use.

I believe there is a genuine and growing need for a facility like this in Belmont. Over the years, I have seen the local population increase and become more diverse, yet community infrastructure has not expanded at the same pace. This proposal would provide structured activities, educational programmes for children, youth engagement initiatives, health and wellbeing support, and dedicated space for women's activities. These are not luxuries - they are essential components of a healthy and cohesive community.

Importantly, the building extensions are modest and appear proportionate to the existing structure. The design remains in keeping with the surrounding residential character and does not represent overdevelopment. The retention of greenery and the inclusion of cycle storage also demonstrate thoughtful planning.

Concerns about parking and traffic have clearly been addressed through the provision of 12 on-site parking spaces, including 2 disabled bays. Given my long-term experience of living immediately next to the site, I do not believe this proposal will cause significant traffic, noise or disturbance beyond what the area has historically accommodated.

What stands out most to me is the opportunity this development presents. For many years, I have watched young people in the area grow up without a dedicated local hub where they can receive guidance, participate in organised programmes and feel a sense of belonging. A well-managed community centre and place of worship would provide structure, support and positive engagement, which ultimately benefits the entire neighbourhood.

Belmont has always been a strong community, but it now needs facilities that reflect its growth and future. After more than 30 years living next to this site, I believe this proposal is a positive and responsible use of the land.

I respectfully ask the Council to approve Planning Application DM2025/01591.